

### 37.4 KEY LANGUAGE REPORTED SPEECH

In reported speech, the main verb often changes tense to a past form. You may also need to change a time or place reference.

I **don't** believe **these** ghost stories.



He said that he **didn't** believe **those** ghost stories.

The present simple "don't" becomes past simple "didn't."

"These" is replaced by the more distant "those."



In reported open questions, the subject comes before the verb and you don't use a question form.

What are you reading?



I asked her what she was reading.



In reported closed questions (with a yes / no answer), you use "if" or "whether."

Are you enjoying it?



I asked her { if / whether } she was enjoying it.



### 37.5 REWRITE THE SENTENCES USING REPORTED SPEECH

Amal has bought a book about ghosts.

Amal said that she had bought a book about ghosts.

① Amal's reading a scary story.

Amal mentioned \_\_\_\_\_

② Amal's finished the book.

Amal told me \_\_\_\_\_

③ Are you going to the movies?

I asked her \_\_\_\_\_

④ What kind of movie are you going to see?

I asked her \_\_\_\_\_

⑤ Did you enjoy it?

I asked her \_\_\_\_\_

